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# Session 2:
# Elicitation
# Requirements Candidates

Stakeholder analysis | AI-assisted summaries/extraction | Problem statement & scope

AI-Augmented Analyst (Zeneeda)

4-hour live session

## What you will leave with today

A stakeholder list + engagement approach
An elicitation plan you can reuse
A set of triaged “requirements candidates”
A first draft problem statement and scope (ready for stakeholder review)

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# Today's plan
(4 hours)

We will alternate **"learn → practice → produce artifacts"**

| | |
|---|---|
| 0:00–0:10 | Recap + outcomes for Session 2 |
| 0:10–0:55 | Stakeholder analysis (who matters, and how to engage them) |
| 0:55–1:25 | Elicitation planning + techniques (interviews, workshops, observation, docs) |
| 1:25–1:35 | Break |
| 1:35–2:20 | AI-assisted summaries + extraction (meeting → candidates) |
| 2:20–2:45 | Problem statement + scope (drafts you can review) |
| 2:45–2:55 | Break |
| 2:55–3:45 | Hands-on lab (capstone case) |
| 3:45–4:00 | Debrief + homework + preview Session 3 |

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# Session 2
# **Objectives**

- Identify and analyze stakeholders (roles, influence, interest, and needs)
- Plan and conduct elicitation using the right technique for the situation
- Use AI to summarize and extract candidates, while keeping evidence and auditability
- Turn raw input into: requirements candidates + open questions + risks + assumptions
- Draft a clear problem statement and a scope boundary (in / out / constraints)

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# Quick recap: Analyst OS loop (from Session 1)

- **Capture:** meeting notes, transcripts, existing docs
- **Extract:** AI summary + entities + candidates
- **Structure:** put candidates into a consistent format (and track questions)
- **Validate:** run quality gates (evidence, correctness, alignment)
- **Communicate:** playback to stakeholders and record decisions

**Today's focus**

- Do "Extract" well (fast, structured, traceable)
- Improve "Validate" by confirming results with stakeholders
- Produce a problem statement + scope to prevent rework

**Reminder**

AI accelerates first drafts; humans own correctness and agreement.

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# Inputs and outputs for Session 2

## Inputs (what we start with)

- Stakeholder names/roles
- Meeting notes or transcript
- Existing process/docs (if any)
- Constraints and success metrics (if known)

## Outputs (what we produce)

- **Stakeholder list + engagement plan**
- **Elicitation plan** (methods + schedule)
- **Requirements candidates** (triaged + classified)
- **Problem statement** (plain language)
- **Scope** (in/out + assumptions + constraints)

### Where these live in your Notion Analyst OS

01 **Stakeholders** 02 **Meetings** 03 **Requirements Candidates**
04 **Decisions/Assumptions** 05 **Risks/Issues**

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# Elicitation: what it is
## (in simple words)

Elicitation means “getting information out of people and documents.”

The goal is shared understanding: needs, rules, data, constraints, and success measures.

Elicitation is not only interviews. It also includes workshops, observation, document review, and more.

You must confirm what you heard (playback) so misunderstandings don’t turn into requirements.

**Key outcome**

Elicitation produces “requirements candidates” — not final requirements yet.

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# Stakeholder analysis: why you do it first

- Stakeholders are people or groups affected by the change, or who can influence it.
- You want the right voices early: decision makers, users, and subject-matter experts.
- Stakeholder analysis helps you plan: who to interview, who to keep informed, and who to “manage closely.”
- It reduces rework because you catch conflicts and missing needs sooner.

**Two quick questions**

- Who can say “yes” (approval)?
- Who will live with the outcome (users/ops)?
- Who knows the rules (compliance/SMEs)?

**Output**

A stakeholder list + engagement approach that you keep updated.

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# Common stakeholder roles
## (analyst-friendly list)

**Sponsor:** funds the work and wants business value

**Product/Process owner:** owns outcomes and priorities

**End users:** do the work day-to-day and know pain points

**Subject-matter experts (SMEs):** know policies, rules, and edge cases

**Operational support:** runs and supports the solution after launch

**Delivery team:** engineering, QA, data, security

**External stakeholders:** customers, suppliers, regulators (if applicable)

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# Stakeholder list template
## (what to capture)

### Recommended fields

- Name, role, team
- Decision authority (Y/N)
- Influence (H/M/L) and interest (H/M/L)
- Goals and pain points
- What they care about (success metrics)
- Preferred channel + meeting cadence
- Notes: risks, concerns, and questions

### Tip for speed

- Start broad, then refine.
- Let AI draft a first stakeholder list from notes, then you validate it.
- Revisit the list every week (new people always appear).

### Notion mapping

Use your “Stakeholders” database from Session 1. Add views: “Decision makers”, “SMEs”, “Needs follow-up”.

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# Power–Interest grid
## (fast stakeholder prioritization)

Idea: plot stakeholders by (1) power to influence outcomes and (2) interest in the change. Then choose how to engage each group.

### Engagement rules of thumb

- **High power + high interest:** manage closely (frequent touchpoints)
- **High power + low interest:** keep satisfied (short updates, key decisions)
- **Low power + high interest:** keep informed (feedback loop)
- **Low power + low interest:** monitor (as needed)

### Simple exercise

- Pick 8–12 stakeholders.
- Place them in a quadrant.
- Decide: who needs interviews vs a workshop vs periodic updates.

**Output**

A prioritized engagement plan that prevents “surprise stakeholders” later.

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# Influence, interest, and impact

(Don’t mix these up)

**Influence (power)**

How much this person/group can affect decisions or funding.

**Interest**

How much they care about this change (good or bad).

**Impact**

How much their day-to-day work will change. High-impact users need a voice.

- A person can have low influence but high impact (e.g., frontline user).
- If you ignore high-impact users, you often get adoption issues later.
- For elicitation: combine the three to pick the right participants.

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# Stakeholder engagement plan

(simple and practical)

- **For each key stakeholder, define:** purpose, frequency, and desired outcome.
- **Examples:** “weekly 15-minute check-in”, “one-time workshop”, “approval gate”.
- Be explicit about decisions: who approves scope, priority, and acceptance criteria.
- **Track engagement risks:** unavailable stakeholders, conflicts, or unclear ownership.

**Template fields**

- Stakeholder
- What they need from us
- What we need from them
- Cadence + channel
- Decision points

**Good sign**

You can explain your engagement plan in 60 seconds.

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# RACI

## (Quick primer for clarity)

**R** = Responsible: does the work

**A** = Accountable: owns the outcome and approves (usually 1 person)

**C** = Consulted: gives input (two-way)

**I** = Informed: kept up to date (one-way)

**Common mistake**

Too many “Accountable” people. Pick one per decision.

**Where to use it in Session 2**

- Who is accountable for confirming elicitation results?
- Who approves the problem statement and scope?
- Who must be consulted on policies and rules?

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# Prepare for elicitation:

## Checklist

- Define the purpose: what do we need to learn or decide?
- Define the scope of the session (so it does not turn into everything).
- Choose the technique(s): interview, workshop, observation, doc review, survey, etc.
- Pick participants (use stakeholder analysis).
- Prepare materials: agenda, questions, artifacts to review, glossary terms.
- Plan capture: notes/transcript, action items, and follow-up questions.
- Plan confirmation: playback, review, or sign-off steps.

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# Choosing an elicitation technique

(simple decision rules)

**Use interviews when…**

- You need depth
- You need sensitive information
- Stakeholders disagree and you need 1:1 context

**Use observation when…**

- Work is complex
- People describe steps differently than reality
- You need “exceptions and workarounds”

**Reality**

Most projects use a mix of techniques.

**Use workshops when…**

- You need alignment across groups
- You need fast discovery
- You need to surface conflicts early

**Use document / interface analysis when…**

- Existing system or SOPs already contain rules
- Stakeholder time is limited
- You need current-state grounding

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# Technique 1:
## Interviews
## (fast and flexible)

**Good for:** deep understanding, roles, rules, and “why” behind requests.

**Prepare:** share purpose, confirm time, and bring a short question list.

**During:** ask open questions first, then clarify with specifics.

**Capture:** record key quotes, decisions, and open questions (don’t rely on memory).

**After:** confirm results with the interviewee (short playback).

**Quick tip**
Ask for examples: “Show me the last time this happened.”

Leading questions (“You want X, right?”).

**Output**
Notes + candidates + questions + confirmation message

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# Interview question patterns

(copy/paste)

### Start broad (open questions)

- “Walk me through your day.”
- “What is hardest or slowest?”
- “What does success look like?”

### Then narrow (clarify)

- “What triggers this step?”
- “What data is required?”
- “What are exceptions?”
- “Who approves?”

### Get to rules and measures

- “How do you decide priority?”
- “What SLA applies, and where is it documented?”
- “How do you know something is done correctly?”

### End with confirmation

- “Let me summarize what I heard…”
- “What did I miss?”
- “What is the next decision we need?”

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# Technique 2:
## Workshops (alignment fast)

Workshops are structured group sessions to discover, clarify, and align.

**Good for:** shared processes, cross-team handoffs, prioritization, and resolving conflicts.

**Key success factors:** clear objective, right participants, tight facilitation, and good capture.

**Watch out for:** dominant voices, silent SMEs, and “scope explosion.”

### Facilitator moves

Timebox | Park “out of scope” items
Use round-robin input | Summarize decisions live

### Output

A shared draft artifact (process map, rules list, backlog) and a decision log.

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# Workshop agenda template

(60 minutes)

**1) 0–5 min:** objective + rules of engagement (what we will decide today) **2) 5–15 min:** current state summary (what we know + what we don't) **3) 15–35 min:** discovery (brainstorm, map steps, list rules/data) **4) 35–50 min:** converge (group similar items, resolve conflicts) **5) 50–58 min:** decide next actions + owners **6) 58–60 min:** playback summary + confirmation

## Capture checklist

Decisions | Assumptions
Open questions | Candidate requirements
Follow-ups

## Success

At the end, everyone agrees on what happens next and what is out of scope.

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# Technique 3:
## Observation
## (see the real work)

- Observation means watching a user do the work (in person or via screen share).
- It reveals workarounds, exceptions, and “hidden rules” people forget to mention.
- Capture: steps, inputs/outputs, delays, handoffs, tools, and pain points.
- Ask clarifying questions after (don’t interrupt too much during the work).

**Observation checklist:** Trigger → steps → decisions → data used → handoffs → exceptions

**Output:** A “current state” step list you can turn into candidates and process maps later.

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# Technique 4:

## Document & interface analysis

Before you book meetings, read what already exists: SOPs, policies, reports, tickets, screenshots.

Document review is fast and reduces stakeholder time.

Look for: business rules, required data fields, approval steps, SLAs, and exceptions.

Interface analysis: inspect forms/screens to infer required inputs and validations.

**AI assist idea**

Ask AI to extract rules and a glossary from a policy document (after redaction).

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# Technique 5:
## Surveys / questionnaires (breadth)

Use surveys when you need input from many people quickly.

Good for: ranking pain points, identifying common issues, capturing variations across sites.

Design tips: keep it short, use clear options, and include one open question at the end.

Follow up with interviews for the most important themes.

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# Confirm elicitation results

## (the “playback” step)

- After elicitation, confirm what you captured for accuracy and consistency.
- Ways to confirm: send a short summary, review notes in the next meeting, or do a quick playback call.
- Focus on: facts, rules, decisions, and open questions.
- This step prevents you from turning misunderstandings into “requirements.”

**Simple playback message**

- “Here is what I heard…”
- “Here are open questions…”
- “Please reply with corrections by <date>.”

**Output**

Confirmed notes + updates to candidates.

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# Common elicitation pitfalls

(and quick fixes)

**Pitfall: Leading questions**

Fix: ask “how” and “why” first; confirm with examples.

**Pitfall: Missing stakeholders**

Fix: ask “Who else should we talk to?” at the end of every session.

**Pitfall: AI output treated as truth**

Fix: always trace back to evidence; confirm with stakeholders.

**Pitfall: Jumping to solutions**

Fix: capture the need and constraint first; park solution ideas.

**Pitfall: Scope creep during elicitation**

Fix: use a parking lot + write “in/out” scope early.

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# Where AI fits in elicitation

## (and where it does not)

**AI is great for**

- Draft summaries and action items
- Extracting entities (systems, roles, data fields)
- Turning notes into candidate requirement statements
- Listing assumptions, risks, and open questions

**Humans must own**

- Correctness (verify critical facts)
- Stakeholder alignment (confirm interpretation)
- Decisions and tradeoffs
- Sensitive context and confidentiality

**Rule**: AI output becomes an artifact only after quality gates + confirmation.

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# AI-assisted meeting capture:

## a safe workflow

Goal: go from raw notes → usable artifacts without losing traceability.

1) **Capture:** take notes or transcript (redact sensitive info if needed).

2) **Summarize:** ask AI for a structured summary + action items.

3) **Extract:** ask AI to pull candidates, rules, data fields, and questions.

4) **Structure:** store items in Notion databases (candidates, risks, decisions).

5) **Confirm:** send playback to stakeholders and update based on feedback.

6) **Log:** record AI use for transparency (prompt + what you verified).

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# Prompt pattern:
## meeting summary (structured)

Copy/paste prompt (edit to your context):

```
ROLE: You are my business analyst assistant.
TASK: Summarize the meeting notes below.
OUTPUT (use these headings):
1) 5-bullet summary (plain language)
2) Decisions (table: decision | owner | date)
3) Action items (table: action | owner | due date)
4) Open questions (list)
CONSTRAINTS:
- Do not invent facts. If unclear, write “unknown”.
- Use short sentences. No jargon.
SOURCE NOTES:
[paste transcript here]
```

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# Prompt pattern:

## extract stakeholders + glossary terms

```
ROLE: You are my analyst assistant.
TASK: From the notes below, extract:
A) Stakeholders mentioned (name/role/team) and what they care about
B) Systems, forms, reports, and data fields mentioned
C) Glossary terms (term | simple definition)
OUTPUT: 3 tables (A, B, C).
CONSTRAINTS: Only use what appears in the notes. If unsure, mark
“needs confirmation”.
SOURCE NOTES:
[paste transcript here]
```

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# Prompt pattern:

## extract “requirements candidates”

```
ROLE: You are my analyst assistant.
TASK: Extract requirements candidates from the notes below.
OUTPUT: a table with columns:
- Candidate statement (one sentence)
- Type (Feature / Rule / Data / Report / NFR)
- Source (quote or short reference)
- Confidence (High/Med/Low)
- Open questions (if any)
CONSTRAINTS:
- Do not merge unrelated items; keep candidates “atomic”.
- Do not add new requirements not present in the notes.
SOURCE NOTES:
[paste transcript here]
```

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# Prompt pattern:

## open questions + risks + assumptions

```
ROLE: You are my analyst assistant.
TASK: Based on the notes below, produce:
1) Open questions (what we must clarify to proceed)
2) Risks/issues (risk | impact | suggested mitigation)
3) Assumptions (assumption | why we made it | how to validate)
CONSTRAINTS: Only use note content. If speculative, mark “hypothesis”.
SOURCE NOTES:
[paste transcript here]
```

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# From notes to “requirements candidates”: the triage pipeline

**Step 1:** Extract candidates from evidence (notes/transcript).

**Step 2:** Classify type (feature, rule, data, report, NFR).

**Step 3:** Add status (new → clarified → accepted/rejected).

**Step 4:** Add confidence (how sure are we?) and open questions.

**Step 5:** Confirm with stakeholders (playback) and update.

### Why “candidates” matter

- Prevents premature commitment
- Makes uncertainty explicit
- Improves quality of final requirements

### Notion mapping

Use the Candidates DB and its fields: Type, Source meeting, Confidence, Status, Open questions.

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# Candidate quality checklist

(quick pass)

## Minimum quality

- **Clear:** one sentence, no vague words (e.g., “easy”, “fast” without a measure).
- **Atomic:** one idea per candidate.
- Traceable: points to a source note or stakeholder statement.
- **Testable:** you can imagine how to verify it.

## If it fails the checklist…

- Rewrite it (simplify).
- Add an open question.
- Lower confidence.
- Mark “needs confirmation.”

## Quality gate (from Session 1)

Evidence • Correctness • Alignment

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# Problem statement:

## what it is
## (and what it is not)

**It is…**

- A plain-language description of the problem and why it matters
- Who is affected and what the impact is
- A clear “gap” between current and desired state

**It is not…**

- A list of features
- A detailed solution design
- Marketing language

**Why analysts care**

- It aligns stakeholders before you write requirements.
- It prevents “solution-first” thinking.
- It gives you a north star for scope decisions.

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# Problem statement template

(simple, reusable)

Fill in the blanks:

**Template**

- **Context:** Today, <who> does <what> using <current approach>.
- **Problem:** They struggle with <pain>, which causes <impact>.
- **Evidence:** We see this in <metric/examples>.
- **Need:** We need to improve <capability> so that <success outcome>.
- **Constraints:** We must consider <constraints> (policy, time, systems).

**Optional framing (SCQA)**

- Situation → Complication → Question → Answer (keep “Answer” high-level).

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# Scope:
## set boundaries early (in / out)

- Scope defines what the initiative will and will not include (for this phase).
- A good scope statement prevents “we thought it was included” surprises.
- Scope should include: in-scope items, out-of-scope items, assumptions, and constraints.
- Add success measures: how you will know the scope delivered value.

**Tip**
Write scope in plain language. Avoid technical implementation details.

**Output**
A one-page scope summary that stakeholders can approve.

**Where it lives**
Notion page + Decisions/Assumptions DB entries when needed.

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# Scope guardrails:

## phase 1 vs phase 2 (MoSCoW)

- MoSCoW categories help teams make scope tradeoffs in a timebox:
- Must have: **cannot succeed without it**
- Should have: **important but not mandatory for the first release**
- Could have: **nice to have if time allows**
- Won't have (this time): **explicitly not included in this release**

**Why it helps**
It makes "out of scope" visible and reduces scope creep.

**Simple rule**
If everything is a Must-have, nothing is.

**Output**
A prioritized candidate list aligned to scope.

# Mini example (capstone): draft problem statement + scope

**Capstone case:** Industrial Maintenance Work Order Modernization

## Draft problem statement (example)

- Today, maintenance teams create and track work orders using inconsistent methods and limited visibility.
- This makes it hard to prioritize, meet SLAs, and reduce downtime.
- Leaders cannot see risk early, and technicians face delays due to missing parts and unclear assignments.
- We need a clearer, trackable work order process and reporting so we can improve SLA compliance and operational visibility.

## Draft scope (Phase 1 example)

- In scope: standardized work order intake, priority + SLA rules, basic assignment, audit history, and weekly reporting.
- Out of scope (phase 2): advanced optimization, full mobile redesign, and “all categories” rollout.
- Assumptions: priority rules are agreed and documented.
- Success measures: fewer SLA breaches, lower backlog, reduced downtime.

**Note**: This is a first draft. You will refine it after confirmation with stakeholders.

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# Hands-on lab(50–60 min):

## Elicitation → candidates → scope

**Goal:** Use a short capstone-style transcript to produce stakeholder-ready artifacts.

**Deliverables by end of lab**

- Stakeholder list updated (8–12 stakeholders, with influence/interest)
- Elicitation plan (next 2 weeks: who/what/when)
- 10+ requirements candidates (classified + confidence + questions)
- 1 problem statement draft + 1 scope draft (in/out + assumptions)
- 1 playback message for stakeholder confirmation
- 1 AI Use Log entry describing what AI did and what you verified

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# Lab Step 1
## — Stakeholder analysis (10–12 min)

- Open your Notion “Stakeholders” database.
- Add 8–12 stakeholders for the maintenance work order case.
- For each: role/team, influence, interest, and what they care about.
- Draft a power–interest grid (just a note is fine).
- Pick 3 “manage closely” stakeholders and 3 “keep informed” stakeholders.

**Output**
A prioritized list that tells you who to talk to first.

**Stretch (optional)**
Add engagement cadence for the top 5 stakeholders.

**AI assist**
Ask AI to suggest missing stakeholders, then validate.

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# Lab Step 2

## Elicitation plan + interview guide (10–12 min)

- Create a one-page elicitation plan in Notion (or a simple table).
- Plan 3 interviews and 1 workshop (who, purpose, technique, outputs).
- Draft 8–10 interview questions using the patterns from earlier slides.
- Add a “confirmation step” (how you will playback results).

**Output**
A plan you can execute next week.

**Tip**
For each session, write the decision or learning goal in one sentence.

**AI assist**
Ask AI to improve question clarity (short, plain language).

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# Lab Step 3

## AI-assisted summary + extraction (20 min)

Paste this short transcript into a new Notion “Meeting” entry. Then run the 3 prompts: summary, stakeholders/glossary, and candidates.

Maintenance Manager: “We have work orders coming from phone calls, WhatsApp, and paper. We lose requests and can’t see what’s urgent.”

Planner: “Priority is inconsistent. Some teams mark everything ‘high’. We need a clear priority rule and SLA targets.”

Technician Lead: “Often we arrive and parts are missing. We need visibility into parts availability and a way to attach photos.”

Operations Lead: “Leadership needs weekly reporting: backlog by priority, SLA breaches, downtime hours, and aging.”

Analyst: “Any constraints?”

Maintenance Manager: “Phase 1 should focus on top 5 work order categories. Also, we need audit history for changes.”

### What to store in Notion

- AI summary as a property
- Action items as a list
- Candidates in the Candidates DB with source meeting

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# Lab Step 2

## Triage + draft problem statement & scope (15–18 min)

- Move extracted candidates into the Candidates DB.
- Classify each candidate (feature/rule/data/report/NFR) and set confidence.
- Rewrite 3 candidates to be clearer and more testable.
- Draft a problem statement using the template (4–7 sentences).
- Draft scope with: in-scope, out-of-scope (phase 2), assumptions, and success measures.
- Write a 5–8 line “playback message” to confirm with stakeholders.
- Create 1 AI Use Log entry: what AI produced + what you verified.

**Success criteria**
A reader can understand the problem and scope without attending the meeting.

**Stretch (optional)**
Add MoSCoW tags (Must /Should /Could/Won’t) to 8 candidates.

**Reminder**
If you are unsure, add an open question instead of guessing.

# Debrief + wrap-up

### Debrief questions

- What did AI do well? Where did it struggle?
- Which candidates were unclear, and how did you fix them?
- What open questions are most risky to leave unanswered?
- Who must confirm scope before Session 3?

### Homework (30–45 min)

- Refine your stakeholder list and engagement plan.
- Add 10 more candidates from your own (real or practice) notes.
- Bring to Session 3: a candidate list you're ready to convert into user stories.

**Next session preview**

Session 3: candidates → user stories, acceptance criteria, and non-functional requirements.